

Budget cell (B8), select “Paste Special...”, and click on “Paste Link”. The reference to B2 will be pasted into the cell. In either of the two methods, any changes to the value of B2 (in the Marketing sheet) will automatically be updated in cell B8 on the Sales sheet.

There is one important difference, though, between using the Link command from the Paste Special menu and entering the cell reference manually. Using the Link command, the reference is absolute; using the other method the reference is relative. See §1.5.2 for more details.

Normally, values and the results of formulas are automatically calculated and updated into the cells as you enter them. In some cases, you may wish to not run the calculation till you have prepared all the formulas and data for your worksheet. If you do not want the values / formulas to be automatically updated, turn off Automatic Calculation: click on the Office Button, select Excel Options, click on Formulas, and select Manual under the Calculation options. Or switch to the Formulas tab, select Calculation options, and choose Manual. Now, whenever you want to calculate the values in your workbook, you will need to press [F9] or the Calculate Now button for Excel to calculate the formulas and values in your workbook. To calculate only the current worksheet, press [Shift] + [F9] or the Calculate Sheet button.

3.4 Absolute, Relative, and Mixed References

An absolute reference is a cell reference that doesn’t change whenever you move your data. On the other hand, a relative cell reference will change every time you move your data.

Copy the data in columns A and B in the



Absolute and relative references